

Choosing plants for special effects

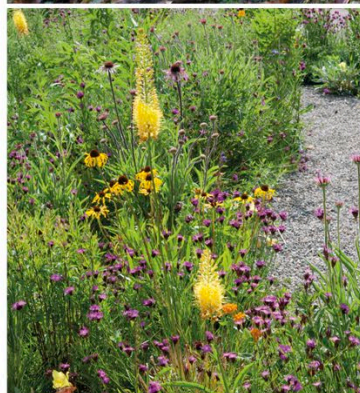
When planning a design, choose plants for their color, texture, shape, and scent, and introduce seasonal changes by using species that add interest at various times. Add evergreens and plants with a bold structure for year-round appeal.

PLANNING YOUR SCHEME

The first section of this book helps you to pinpoint plants that thrive in the particular conditions of your site, while this second section focuses on sense and style by providing you with a selection of plants that can be used to create a particular design or achieve a specific effect. For example, you may be looking for ideas to create a Asian-style garden, or plants that will draw a range of birds and insects to a wildlife border. Also look at pp.14–17, which explain how to group plants to achieve certain effects, such as a formal or contemporary design.

Once you have chosen a style, you should think about introducing seasonal interest to keep the color going and attract attention throughout the year. This is particularly important in small plots, where the whole space is on view at all times. When selecting seasonal plants, try to combine those that flower or fruit consecutively to avoid peaks and troughs—the description of each plant featured tells you whether it is an early-, mid-, or late-season performer. Also, combine your blooming plants with leafy species and evergreens for long-lasting appeal.

GARDEN STYLES



Creating a style To produce a chosen garden style, select an appropriate palette of plants. The Asian-style garden above uses architectural plants in muted colors to offset the bold features.

Using plants Combine plants within a style so that they contrast or complement each other. Here yellow foxtail lilies contrast with the adjacent purple dianthus (*left*).

SEASONAL INTEREST



Seasonal highlights To capture the essence of a season, use plants that celebrate that time of year, such as spring bulbs or trees with fiery fall leaves, like the Japanese maple above.

Retaining interest The flowers of many plants, such as sea holly (*left*) and hydrangeas, dry in place, and last into winter, providing interest for more than one season.